

An invitation, to gather

What can we do together?

We are entering a time when computing systems are becoming deeply capable. We are being invited to show up differently, to work in different ways.

This shift raises a question that is less technical than it is deeply human: **What kinds of intelligences and sense-making capabilities do we need to cultivate in ourselves, as we learn to adapt to these newer kinds of agencies?**

Gathering Intelligences and Agencies is a series of introductory workshops, meetings and gatherings to explore what sense making we need to respond to, evaluate and collaborate with agentic intelligences.

Gathering intelligences & Sensing Agencies

Introductory workshops, meetings and gatherings that resist the logic of '*atomic optimisation*' and instead seek care-full sense-making and collaboration in service of planetary health and social justice. A civic.interplay initiative.

Gatherings

Sydney	11 March 2026 12pm - 2pm, Impact Lab
Melbourne	12 March 2026 230pm - 4pm, RMIT
Online	Check details for online gatherings
& Then	Collaboration spaces to make together

We have questions

If the internet is becoming a space that machines build, design and communicate through, what space does this open up for embodied humans, with custodianship of Country, with vulnerable bodies and concern for endangered species and a rapidly-heating planet?

If data is best computed by agents, what stories can we share? What different tools can artists, storytellers, poets, non-developers build now that code can be accessed through natural language?

If platforms are breaking, and agents are building, what collaborations can we spark to support different forms of care and connection?

No prior AI expertise is required. This is an initial gathering opportunity to ask questions and connect with others.

Hosted by:

Dr. Sarah Barns

Public historian and researcher, civic AI practitioner, creative director and founder. Co-director of Studio ESEM and STORYBOX, current Vice Chancellor's Senior Research Fellow, RMIT University.

You don't need to like AI!

This is not for the technology-obsessed (even if we are, a little). We are interested in connecting artists, researchers, technologists, curators, social entrepreneurs and community builders to explore what it means to work with AI in ways that are relational, conscious, and collaborative.

What Happens Next

From the Sydney and Melbourne sessions, we aim to:

1. Identify a cohort of collaborators interested in sustained concept design and practice development
2. Document the intelligences, methods, and questions that emerge across both workshops.
3. Develop a shared framework for 'gathering intelligence' as a practice—applicable across participants' diverse contexts.
4. Scope specific projects and partnerships that apply the methodology to live challenges—in community development, cultural production, evaluation, civic technology, and beyond.

Irina Panovich

Researcher, writer, and consultant focused on distributed systems and coordination tech prototyping new models of collective decision-making and digital-physical coordination.